

- Promoted the reinforcement of the concerns of women issues in the media,
- Discussed and putting directions for future women empowerment through the media

Ongoing activities

- An orientation program for 900 journalism students to develop their professional responsibility in six (6) universities in Ethiopia is in progress. The project is being implemented with the support from Friedrich-Ebert-Stiftung (FES), Addis Ababa;
- A project, in collaboration with Federal Ethics and Anti-Corruption Commission and supported by Commercial Bank of Ethiopia is underway. Its purposes are:
- Conducting assessment on the participation and skills of women media practitioners in exposing corruption and implementing investigating journalism;
- Conducting training workshop for 60 women media practitioners on investigative journalism and media ethics in three rounds;
- Awarding best female journalists who produced programs/articles related to ethics and anti-corruption activities, through different media outlets and
- Out of the journalists who produce media programs/articles on corruption issues, nine journalists are to be awarded for their respective top nine programs.

Key areas of planned partnership with potential donors

- Improve women journalists' skills on media quality, and women's related issues;
- Conduct research in the field of media women issues;
- Strengthen EMWA's Resource Center;
- Publish EMWA's quarterly magazine;
- Solicit fellowship programs and scholarships for members;
- Work to enhance members' skill maternal health, newborn child health and nutrition in reaching women, and
- Work through the media to end FGM.
- Capacitate journalists and work through the media to end FGM



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Produced radio programs and newspaper articles on violence against women and conducted community conversation on the issue.

- Contributed to a campaign for women candidates by developing bill boards, and conducting training for women contestants.
- Initiated the establishment of Reproductive Health Network Journalists in regions in which EMWA members are focal persons.
- Involved in activities of empowering the media for promotion of human rights, an action that was supported by UN Office for High Commissioner for Human Rights (OHCHR) and Ethiopian Human rights Commission (EHRC).
- Conducted surveys and various media literacy workshops.
- Conducted media monitoring on various occasions including print media monitoring on the representation of children and issues affecting children (with the support of well as women's rights and issues of women's concerns (with the support of FK). The Association also conducted a content analysis on the representation of women in print media in election news in 2006 with the support of Action Aid Ethiopia.
- Quarterly magazines are produced and distributed to members and the public at large.
- Through financial support obtained from Micronutrient Initiative (MI) EMWA implemented a nation-wide campaign project entitled "Vitamin A Supplementation Behavior Change Communication (VAS SBCC)". Through the project, the following achievements were registered:
 - Improved women journalists' capacity to effectively communicate to mothers and care givers on the importance of vitamin A supplementation (VAS) through media channels;
 - Journalists were able to develop VAS SBCC media programs;
 - Developed and disseminated VAS SBCC programs through available media outlets in seven regions of Ethiopia, and on EMWA's Fan page Face book;
 - Trained journalists, developed field based stories on VASBCC
 - Hosted panel discussions and arranged for broadcast on child nutrition and vitamin A supplementation issues using national mass media such as Radio and TV, and
 - Media monitoring for VAS SBCC messages, field based stories and panel discussions were conducted.
 - Out of the journalists who produced media programs, the top nine programs were awarded.
- EMWA in collaboration with US Embassy organized a one-day seminar on the role of women Journalists in promoting women's issues in the media. The project objectives focused on:
 - improving women's representation and change negative portrayal in the media through strengthening capacities of women journalists,
 - increasing the awareness level of 60 EMWA member media practitioners in their respective roles of addressing women's concerns in their respective media.

Membership

Currently, the Association has over 200 members (full and associate) in Addis Ababa & Dire Dawa City Administrations, regions of Amhara, Tigray, Oromiya, Southern Nations Nationalities and Harari. Its members are women journalists, media educators and communication and PR practitioners drawn both from government and private media. EMWA's by-laws allow interested people to join EMWA as associate members. There are three types of membership:

Ordinary/Regular membership: is open for every Ethiopian women with a minimum of one year experience in media or communications, or with at least a diploma in the fields of Journalism & communications.

Associate membership: An Ethiopian woman or man from any profession who supports EMWA's objectives can join EMWA as an associate member.

Honorary membership: An individual or an entity that accepts the Association's objectives and that has provided considerable contributions to the Association in terms of money and/or profession can be registered as honorary member on condition of acceptance by the EMWA General Assembly.

Strategy

- Capacity building for member journalists and media practitioners;
- Develop guidelines and resources on gender and media issues;
- Solicit scholarships for members;
- Conduct researches and studies on women media practitioners, Ethiopian women's representation in, and their access, to media;
- Advance professional freedom, excellence and ethical conduct among its members, and
- Create networks with national and international media houses, women professional organizations and other organizations working with/for women.

Structure

The Association has General Assembly, Executive Board comprised of seven members and a secretariat. The general Assembly is the supreme body of the EMWA, and the board is the next governing body of the Association.

Ethiopian Media Women Association (EMWA) is a non-partisan, not-for-profit association established by like-minded women journalists and media professionals, and registered at Ministry of Justice in 1999. Following the Charities and Societies proclamation No.621/2009, EMWA reregistered as an Ethiopian resident society in 2013.

Since 1999, EMWA has been working towards the realization of its objectives by implementing various projects and programs in areas of raising the skills of media professionals and practitioners, enabling women to own and become beneficiary of alternative and community media, creating gender sensitive media in Ethiopia, improving women access and participation in the media, improving the image and representation of women in the media as well as the public's perspective.

Vision

EMWA is a vibrant professional association aspiring to create professionally skilled, educated and confident Ethiopian women media practitioners who can bring a difference both nationally and internationally.

Mission

EMWA's mission is to support women media practitioners through capacity building, and to increase their involvement in managerial positions and the media.

Values

- Participation and engagement
- Faithfulness
- Accountability
- Transparency
- Impartiality
- Professional ethics
- Fairness and equity
- Endurance
- Efficiency and effectiveness
- Gender equity

Objectives

EMWA's major objectives are:

- Raising and empowering members' professional skills;
- Increasing members' access and participation in the media;
- Supporting members to own and/or benefit from alternative/community media;
- Enhancing members' economic and social benefits;
- Conducting researches on members' professional, economic and social participation

Major Achievements

Since 1999 EMWA has been working towards the realization of its objectives by implementing various projects and programs. The following projects and programs can be cited as EMWA's major achievements:

- In collaboration with Friedrich Ebert-Stiftung (FES), gender sensitive trainings were delivered to journalists.
- In collaboration with Norwegian government agency, Fredskropset (FK), North-South and south-South experience sharing program was conducted, and the program benefited 19 members.
- EMWA has established strong partnership with Media Women Association of Kenya (AMWIK), Uganda (UMWA), Tanzania (TAMWA) and Zambia (ZAMWA). The Association was also able to organize a regional partners meetings and conferences.
- Through assistance from Oak Foundation, EMWA was able to associate with other three African similar associations namely TAMWA, UMWA, and AMWIK, and as a result of the collaboration, a media code of conduct that guides how to report on Child Sexual Abuse and Exploitation (CSAE) was prepared and published.
- With regard to capacity building of its members and the media, the association has carried out different programs including trainings for a total of six (5) members in Uganda, through financial and technical supports received from FES.
- EMWA has managed to establish strong national and international networks which enabled it to promote regional cooperation and to contribute towards building image of the country. EMWA participated in international campaigns such as Global Media Monitoring Project (GMMP).
- In collaboration with Ethiopian Millennium Foundation (SEM), EMWA published a book in Amharic about the contemporary women leaders in history, under the title: Candace: Invincible Women of Ethiopia.
- In conjunction with UNICEF, EMWA organized round table discussions on issues of women and children specifically on reducing maternal and child mortality and awarded Ethiopian journalists for their exceptional contributions on safe motherhood.
- Produced radio programs under OAK project on child rights and related issues.
- Accomplished media campaign against Harmful Traditional practices (HTPs) with the support of Norwegian Churches.